



Civic Meeting Report

Muncie City Council Meeting October 7th 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=moEN8c9Zw4A
Publication Date	2024-10-08T01:03:53Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Report: Common Council of the City of Muncie

Meeting Date: October 7, 2024

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Statutory Public Hearing regarding proposed annexation [00:00:25](#).
- **Summary of Discussion:** Kathy Van Ice of Ashton Land Surveyors presented on Ordinance 25-24, detailing a voluntary annexation request for two parcels located on the northwest corner of Bethel and Morrison (properties associated with the Amy Edinson Trust and Janine Soders). Van Ice explained that the East halves were annexed previously, and this action aims to combine the West halves to prevent landlocked parcels and unify them within a single taxing unit. No members of the public spoke during the hearing, and it was closed by the presiding officer.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the regular meeting to order for October 7, 2024 [00:13:42](#).
 - **Attendance:**
 - *Present:* Members Mason, Green, Goan, Bastion, Dishman (President), Pal (remote), and others as noted via roll call.
 - *Absent:* Member Garrett (noted absent during roll calls).
 - *Presiding Officer:* Council President Dishman.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance led by Sarah [00:13:51](#).
 - Invocation delivered by Devin Mitchell of First Lady of Deliverance Temple [00:14:12](#).
 - Citizen Recognition presented by Ro Shelby honoring Dorica Young Watson (social worker, certified life coach, and community advocate) [00:15:08](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Motion to approve the minutes of September 9, 2024, passed by roll call vote [00:21:43](#).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:22:30](#) **Committee Reports & Announcements:**
 - Member Dell Basham reported on a lengthy and in-depth State Board of Accounts exit meeting where the city received high marks across the board.
 - Member Nora Pal announced a final Finance Committee work session for committee members to clarify budget and department cut details on October 16, 2024, at 6:00 PM at City Hall [00:23:59](#).
- [00:24:59](#) **Ordinance 16-24: Additional Appropriations <U+2013> Fire Department EMS**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Introduced previously. Union President Local 348 (Ston Cha) noted this item was already voted on during the previous meeting and appeared on the current agenda by mistake [00:25:26](#). No formal action taken.
- [00:25:24](#) **Ordinance 17-24: Rezoning from R4 to MHR for 7001, 7003<U+2013>7111 West 15th Street and 801 West 15th Street**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Introduced by council.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Due to a lack of representation or presentation by the petitioner, a motion was made and seconded to table the ordinance [00:26:52](#).
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Passed Unanimously to Table [00:27:19](#).

- **00:27:34 Ordinance 18-24: Rezoning from R4 to BV (Variety Business) for EC Anthony<U+2019>s First Addition**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Chris Badger with Badger Engineering.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Badger explained the rezoning serves to clean up a split zoning issue across a parking lot where a new church fellowship hall is being constructed **00:28:02**.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Approved by Roll Call Vote (**00:29:59**).
- **00:30:19 Ordinance 19-24: Amending Traffic Schedule (Chapter 80) <U+2013> Speed Limit Reduction Around West View School**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Member Pal.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Lowers the speed limit around West View School from 30 to 25 miles per hour and ensures signs are placed on Riley Road and Gilbert Street. Muncie Police Captain Chris Degan spoke in favor for enforcement and safety purposes **00:33:24**.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Approved by Roll Call Vote (**00:35:25**).
- **00:35:43 Ordinance 20-24: Additional Appropriations <U+2013> Muncie Police Department**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Chris Degan, Muncie Police Department.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Brief Q&A with the council; no major debates.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Approved by Roll Call Vote (**00:36:31**).
- **00:36:53 Ordinance 21-24: Proposed Muncie Public Transportation Budget**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Board/Staff.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Noted that final action on this budget and related district budgets will be taken at a special meeting on October 23 **00:37:23**.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Deferred / Held for special meeting. (*Note: Public comment regarding budget cuts was heard during this block from resident Christopher Bilbury 00:39:40*).
- **00:42:41 Ordinance 24-24: Amending Chapter 76 <U+2013> Abandoned Vehicles**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Member Mason and Chris Degan (Muncie Police Department / Code Enforcement).
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Establishes local operational procedures and code enforcement arms for junk and abandoned vehicles, shifting handling from strictly state code to local procedures to capture towing fees locally **00:43:00**. Clerk Belinda Muncie raised concerns regarding the Violations Bureau jurisdiction, classic/hobby car valuation thresholds, and fund routing **00:48:53**.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Introduced/Approved by Voice Vote (**00:54:14**).
- **00:54:14 Ordinance 25-24: Voluntary Annexation of Real Property (Edinson / Soders)**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Kathy Van Ice (Ashton Land Surveyors).
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Formal introduction of the annexation ordinance for the 4-acre property near Bethel and Morrison to combine split parcels **00:54:43**.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Approved for Introduction by Voice Vote (**01:00:56**).

- **01:01:11 Ordinance 26-24: Establishing Designated Outdoor Refreshment Areas (DORAs)**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Mayor Dan Ridenour, Member Pal, Member Goan, and City Attorney Dan Gibson **01:04:30**.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Creates three DORA zones (Downtown, Ball State Village, and McKinley neighborhood) allowing open containers of alcoholic beverages in designated cups within specified boundaries **01:04:39**. Extensive debate occurred regarding policing, family-friendliness, neighborhood input, and economic impacts **01:15:00**.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Introduced with dissenting votes recorded (Approved by Voice Vote / Majority) **01:30:42**.
- **01:30:52 Resolution 10-24: Fiscal Plan for Voluntary Annexation (Edinson/Soders)**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Mayor Dan Ridenour and City Attorney Dan Gibson **01:31:58**.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Required fiscal plan confirming zero additional cost to the city to extend services to the 4-acre annexed area **01:33:01**.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Adopted by Roll Call Vote (**01:34:20**).
- **01:34:28 Resolution 11-24: Ratifying and Approving BOT Agreement for Replacement Fire Station 6**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Greg Marts (GM Development) **01:35:04**.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Marts presented updates on the Station 6 project, noting a slight site shift to higher ground in McCullough Park to avoid recurrent flooding with no cost increase **01:38:28**. Council members debated adding formal language prioritizing local labor.
 - *Item-Specific Public Input:* Public comments by Ozzie Barber and Christopher Bilbury questioned costs and process transparency **01:46:07**.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Adopted as amended (contingent upon inclusion of language prioritizing local labor) by Roll Call Vote **01:55:35**.
- **01:36:34 Resolution 12-24: Appropriations Reduction Resolution (General Fund)**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Administration / DLGF compliance.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Resolution to reduce current-year general fund appropriations as requested by the Department of Local Government Finance (DLGF) **01:07:09**. Council members questioned reducing active accounts near year-end, particularly police/fire lines **02:00:00**. An amendment was successfully passed to correct a department numbering error in Section 1 **02:02:24**.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Adopted as amended by Roll Call Vote **02:03:43**.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **02:05:34 Ozzie Barber:** Addressed the council to demand support for union contract negotiations (reference to "Ask Me" / local municipal labor contracts), urging the council

to withhold approval from the administration until worker agreements are resolved.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Reminder of the upcoming Finance Committee meeting on October 16, 2024, at 6:00 PM [01:41:25](#).
 - Reminder of the upcoming special meeting on October 23, 2024, for final budget actions [00:37:23](#).
 - **Adjournment:** Motion to adjourn made and seconded; meeting officially adjourned [02:08:08](#).
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